

AI ADOPTION REPORT · BARIATRIC & SURGICAL PRACTICES

AI is reshaping Bariatric & Surgical Practices. The sequence determines who wins.

Insurance approval is the bottleneck. AI moves patients from consult to surgery date faster.

39 PAs/wk

prior authorizations per physician per week — bariatric surgery carries some of medicine's heaviest payer documentation (AMA 2024 PA Survey)

\$100K+

in annual revenue recoverable for a small surgical practice through AI scheduling and fewer no-shows (bam.ai, 2026)

13 hrs/week

average physician time on prior authorization alone — before appeals or nutrition/psych clearance coordination (AMA 2024)

WHERE AI CREATES MEASURABLE ROI IN BARIATRIC & SURGICAL PRACTICES

AI qualification tracking

Tracks each patient's payer-required steps (diet, psych eval, nutrition consult) and flags what's missing — the top cause of delayed surgery dates.

Automated PA + appeals

Drafts submissions and appeal letters in payer-specific medical necessity language — cuts the 13 hrs/week burden.

AI scheduling + no-show prediction

Predictive risk plus reminders cut no-shows 24–40%, recovering \$100K+/year in a small practice (bam.ai, 2026).

Pre/post-op care coordination

Automated check-ins track pre-op compliance and post-op recovery — fewer day-of cancellations, earlier complication catches.

Ambient AI documentation

Captures consults and drafts notes live — physicians get 1–2 hrs/day back from charting (AMA, 2024–25).

Long-term outcomes automation

Automated nutrition check-ins and support-group follow-up keep patients in-practice instead of drifting to a competitor.

WHAT HAPPENS AS COMPETITORS ADOPT AI

Bariatric surgery has one of the longest, most document-heavy paths from consult to surgery date in medicine. Whoever removes the friction wins the referral.

- AI-tracked qualification steps get patients to a surgery date in weeks, not months — patients and referring PCPs both notice.
- Automated PA and appeals cut the denials that cause patients to abandon the process — lost patients are lost revenue and lost outcomes data.
- Lower no-show rates from predictive scheduling protect the practice's scarcest resource: OR block time.
- Automated multi-year follow-up keeps patients in the practice's network instead of drifting elsewhere.
- Within 18–24 months, practices with an automated qualification-to-surgery pipeline convert consults to completed surgeries at a meaningfully higher rate.

THE WIDENING GAP

The practices winning in bariatric surgery aren't marketing harder — they're removing the friction between a patient's decision to have surgery and the day it happens. AI removes that friction at scale.

FREE 30-MIN STRATEGY CALL

Map your AI path forward — where to start, what to automate, and what to do first.


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